

TASTE AND SMELL



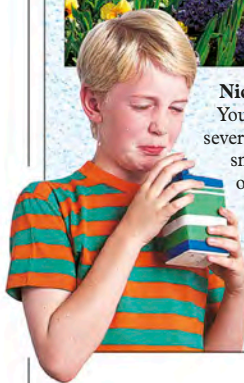
Your senses of taste and smell are very closely linked. They depend on each other. Tiny dimples on your tongue, and hairs at the top of the inside of your nose, detect chemicals that cause tastes and smells. Special sensory cells then send messages through to your brain to be recognized. Your sense of smell is twenty thousand

times stronger than your sense of taste! Often what you think you are tasting you are really just smelling.



Nice and not so nice

You are able to distinguish several thousand different smells. The clean smell of the countryside can be lovely, but the smell of milk that has spoiled is horrible. Bad smells can warn you not to drink or eat things that are not fresh.



The roof of your mouth, the back of your throat, and your tongue are covered in small dimples called taste buds.

As the food is pushed around your mouth by your tongue, your taste buds pick up its taste.

Taste buds can only detect the flavors of food that has been dissolved in saliva.

When you want to smell something, you have to suck air right up to the top of your nose to reach your smell sense cells.

The smell of tasty food automatically makes you produce saliva.

